

MANAGER DEVELOPMENT JAM SESSION · TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 3

Manager Voyage *prototype* review.

Review the feedback on the Manager Voyage prototype and agree on the refinements before the next version.

AGENDA · 60 MINUTES

Today's *agenda*.

01
Recap
Update on progress since the first jam session.

02
Prototype reveal
The journey, the standard, and the four components, live.

03
Feedback review
What we are hearing from DAR, Facilities, VBOM and USAC staff.

04
Discussion
Where the feedback converges, where it diverges, and what we change.

05
Open item
Hiring manager data: internal versus external.

06
Next steps
Owners and dates to the next version and to launch.

01 · RECAP

What you asked for in the first jam session, and what we *built*.

Five themes from the first jam session. Each one is now built into the prototype.

YOU STATED

Make it practical.

WE LISTENED

Real conversations, a three-tap week, the templates.

YOU STATED

Learn across Vanderbilt.

WE LISTENED

Cross-unit cohorts, labs on someone else's case.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

YOU STATED

Learn by doing.

WE LISTENED

Rehearse in a lab, then do it for real.

YOU STATED

Build the talent bench.

WE LISTENED

Coaching, delegation, a 90-day plan by name.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

YOU STATED

Reinforce how we lead.

WE LISTENED

One standard, taught, practiced, measured.

WHAT EACH THEME CHANGED, IN FULL

Make it practical.

"Give managers simple tools for 1:1s, people decisions, difficult situations, and the everyday work of managing."

Every activity in the Foundation course is a conversation a manager will actually have, and the course ends with a three-tap week the manager adds to their calendar: 1:1s, the team meeting, the monthly and quarterly work, and what to do as needed.

The Manager Portal holds the 1:1 agenda, the three-line conversation frame, the delegation ladder, and every policy route with the office it goes to, from Day 1 onward.

Learn across Vanderbilt.

"Use cross-functional cohorts to build relationships, empathy, and a better understanding of how the university works."

The four-week cohort seats fifty managers a quarter from across the 39 business units, in small SparkWise Learning Labs that work a live case from someone else's team, with a classroom week one and a capstone where managers present to peers from other units.

The Vanderbilt & Nashville track covers the mission, the areas of focus, our campuses, and how we work together, and Who to call names the people a manager's team depends on.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

WHAT EACH THEME CHANGED, IN FULL

Learn by doing.

"Blend in-person experiences, real scenarios, SMEs, and practice in the flow of work."

The course teaches through live conversations with a team member who answers back, scored on what the manager says. The cohort rehearses each week's conversation in a simulation lab tailored to the manager's own team, then has it for real: one 1:1 cadence set, one hard conversation held, one decision handed over, with the manager's own team.

Subject-matter experts from seven divisions wrote the routing rules and the Day 30 and Day 60 expectations, and fifteen managers from eight units tested the whole program first.

Build the talent bench.

"Help managers spot potential, create enrichment opportunities, enable lateral and diagonal mobility, and develop their successors."

Growing people and handing over decisions, not just tasks, are written into the standard itself. Week 3 of the cohort is coaching and mentoring: for each person on the team, where they want to be, one stretch assignment, and their rung on the delegation ladder.

The Team Development Plan sets 90-day growth moves by name, is challenged by peers in week 4, and is presented to the business unit leader at the capstone.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

WHAT EACH THEME CHANGED, IN FULL

Reinforce how we lead.

"Build shared expectations around collaboration, accountability, sound people practices, and care for frontline staff."

The Vanderbilt Manager Standard: four expectations of every manager, adapted from Yukl's research, the same in every business unit, taught in the course, measured by the ten-statement assessment before the program and again at 90 days, and practiced in the cohort.

Compliance and the People track put sound people practice on every manager's path, and taking care of the people on the team is one of the four categories, not an elective.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

THE COMMITMENTS WE MADE IN THE ROOM, AND WHERE THEY LED

Next steps named at the jam session

- Validate internal versus external hiring manager data.
- Invite DAR and Facilities as volunteer pilot partners.
- Present the manager development prototype to VBOM for feedback and further refinement.
- Schedule the next session to review and refine the prototype.

How the program keeps listening

- The pulse survey before week one and again at the capstone, and the week-four recap, where managers say what happened when they tried it.
- The ten-statement assessment before the course, at the capstone, and three months on, which shows where the program is working and where it is not.
- Feedback from each cohort shapes the next quarter's design, the same way the pilot shaped this one.

From the jam session to launch

STEP 1

Jam session

Managers and leaders set the five themes and the next steps.

STEP 2

Expert group

Seven divisions defined the routing rules, Who to call, and the Day 30 and Day 60 expectations.

STEP 3 · MARCH 26, 2026

Pilot

Fifteen managers from eight units completed the full program. Their feedback shaped the current design.

STEP 4 · JANUARY 2027

Launch

Open to all managers, with the first cohort of fifty.

02 · PROTOTYPE REVEAL

The Vanderbilt Manager Standard: four *expectations*.

One standard, every business unit. Taught, measured, practiced.

01

Get the work done

through the team, not around it

02

Take care of your people

listen, grow, thank, trust

03

Make things better

explain the why, let people try, look back

04

Connect your team

to the rest of Vanderbilt

Adapted from Gary Yukl's four categories of leadership behavior. Ten assessment statements, before the course, at the capstone, and three months on.

YUKL, 2012 · ACADEMY OF MANAGEMENT PERSPECTIVES ↗

YUKL, GORDON AND TABER, 2002 · THE TAXONOMY ↗

DERUE ET AL., 2011 · META-ANALYSIS ↗

GOOGLE RE:WORK · PROJECT OXYGEN ↗

GALLUP · STATE OF THE AMERICAN MANAGER ↗

The standard, *continued*.

WHERE THE STANDARD COMES FROM, AND HOW THE ASSESSMENT MEASURES IT

The standard is adapted from Gary Yukl's taxonomy of leadership behavior (*Academy of Management Perspectives*, 2012). The four expectations are his four categories, the fifteen behaviors are his fifteen, and each of the ten assessment statements is one behavior written as something a manager does in a normal week. Five behaviors have no statement of their own (problem solving, developing, envisioning change, encouraging innovation, networking), so the ten statements sample the standard and the course teaches all fifteen. A self-reflection tool adapted for Vanderbilt, not a validated Yukl instrument, and not a performance evaluation.

EXPECTATION	YUKL'S CATEGORY	THE FIFTEEN BEHAVIORS	ASSESSMENT STATEMENTS
01 Get the work done	Task-oriented	Planning, clarifying, monitoring, problem solving	1 Priorities, 2 Expectations, 3 Checking work
02 Take care of your people	Relations-oriented	Supporting, developing, recognizing, empowering	4 Supporting, 5 Recognizing, 6 Empowering
03 Make things better	Change-oriented	Advocating change, envisioning change, encouraging innovation, facilitating collective learning	7 Leading change, 8 Looking back
04 Connect your team	External	Networking, external monitoring, representing	9 Watching ahead, 10 Representing

02 · PROTOTYPE REVEAL

The four *components* of Manager Voyage.

Assigned automatically from the HR record. Four parts.

4,600+
Staff led by Vanderbilt managers

500+
Vanderbilt managers

39
Business units using the same standard

60
Days covered by the initial path

01 · REQUIRED

Compliance

DAYS 1 TO 60

Legal and policy, by state.

02 · STRONGLY RECOMMENDED

Foundations

COURSE BY DAY 7

Assessment, 35-minute course, micro modules.

03 · OPTIONAL BUT RECOMMENDED

Four-week cohort

QUARTERLY

Practice with your own team.

04 · ALWAYS AVAILABLE

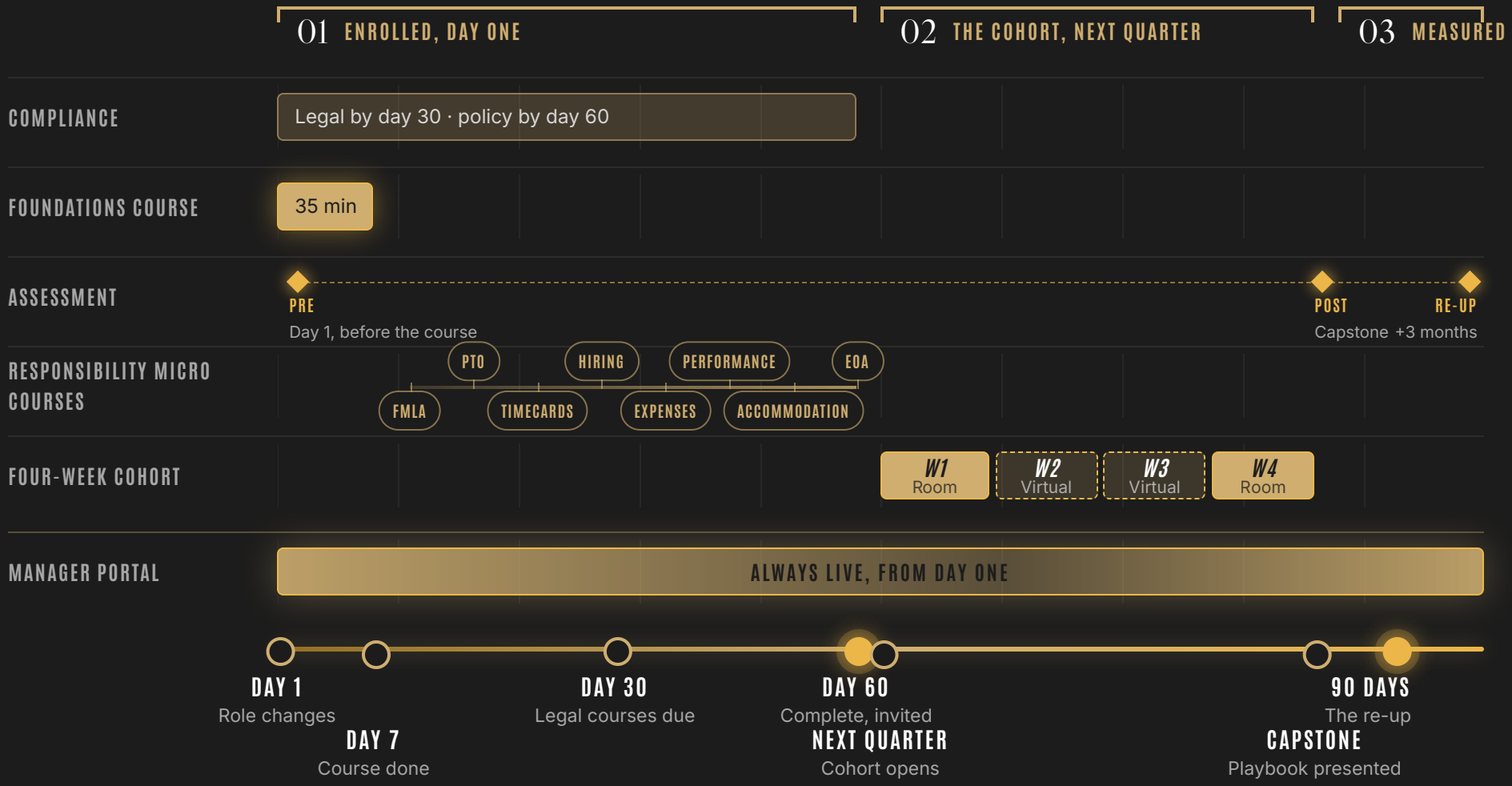
Manager Portal

ALWAYS LIVE

Templates, policy, who to call.

02 · PROTOTYPE REVEAL

The manager's *timeline*, day one to ninety.



The manager's journey, *continued*.

EACH STAGE, IN A SENTENCE

Day 1, enrolled

- **Enrolled on the first day.** Oracle Learning assigns compliance and Manager Foundations from the HR record. Nothing to request.
- **Compliance.** The legal and policy courses for the state the team works in, supervisor versions included. Legal by day 30, policy by day 60.
- **The Foundations course.** *You Are a Manager Now*, thirty-five minutes online by day seven: the assessment first, then six topics with live conversations, scored.

Days 7 to 60, responsibilities

- **Micro courses, one task each.** FMLA and leave, PTO and timecards, hiring, expenses, the performance cycle, accommodations, reporting to EOA. Short, in Oracle Learning, taken as the responsibility arrives.
- **Day 60.** Recorded against the job profile. The cohort invitation goes out.

Next quarter, the cohort

- **Enroll.** The enrollment survey: a seat request and the team profile, four taps that tailor every scenario.
- **Four weeks.** Week 1 in the classroom, three hours. Weeks 2 and 3 virtual, under ninety minutes. Week 4 the capstone, two hours, the Playbook presented.
- **A survey after every session, then completion.**

Measured, and always live

- **Measured three times.** Before the course, again at the capstone, and the re-up three months on: the same statements, scored beside the first result, and the team's view from three or more direct reports.
- **The Manager Portal.** Every template, policy link and contact, open from the first day and never taken away.

02 · PROTOTYPE REVEAL · DAYS 1 TO 60

Manager Foundations: the assessment, the course, the *micro modules*.

In order. Assigned to every current manager too.

01

The assessment

PRE, POST, AND THE RE-UP AT THREE MONTHS

Ten statements, scored by expectation.

02

The Foundation course

35 MINUTES · COMPLETE BY DAY 7

You Are a Manager Now. Six topics, live conversations.

03

The micro modules

DAYS 1 TO 60 · ORACLE LEARNING

One task each, four tracks.

Done by Day 60: recorded against the job profile, cohort invitation sent.

THE SIX TOPICS AND THE FOUR TRACKS

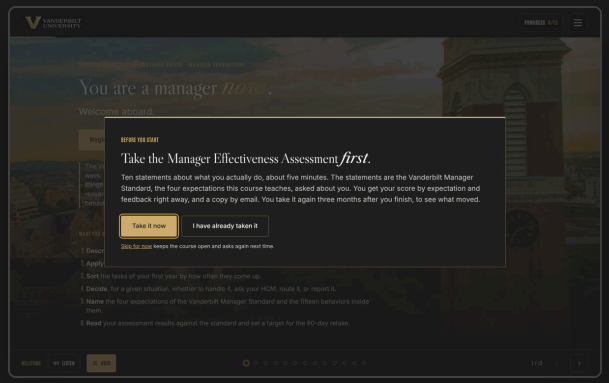
The Foundation course, six topics

- **What a manager is.** The one change, three things that are new, who helps you.
- **Five ideas.** Priorities, clear expectations, psychological safety, purpose, the people work. A live conversation for each.
- **Your first year.** What Vanderbilt asks for and when, and a three-tap week the manager adds to their calendar.
- **The Vanderbilt Manager Standard.** The four expectations, Yukl's category for each, the fifteen behaviors on flip cards, a story per expectation, and the map from expectation to assessment statement, then four live conversations.
- **Your assessment.** The result by expectation, which statements sit under each, and the first move.
- **Next steps.** One action this week, a note to their manager, course complete.

The micro modules, four tracks

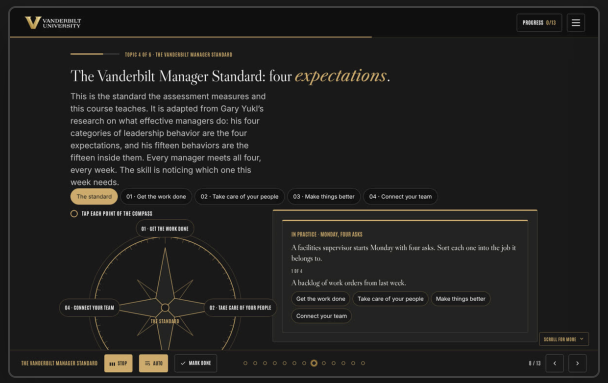
- **Systems, by Day 30.** UKG for managers; Oracle time off; Oracle HCM team view and approvals; Oracle Recruiting and Onboarding; expense and procurement approvals.
- **Vanderbilt & Nashville, by Day 30.** The mission and vision; areas of focus; our campuses; Nashville; how we work together.
- **People, by Day 60.** Employee Relations grounding; EOA reporting duty; FMLA; reasonable accommodations; performance concerns simulator; onboarding a new hire.
- **Processes, by Day 60.** Performance Management Foundations; giving feedback; compensation and merit basics; flexible work; offboarding and transitions.

The Foundations course, *page by page*.



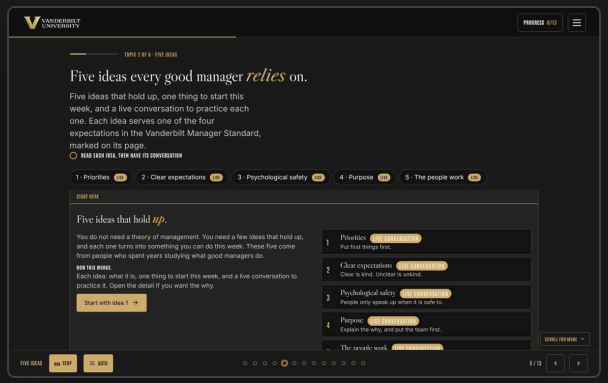
ASSESSMENT FIRST

Ten statements before the course opens.



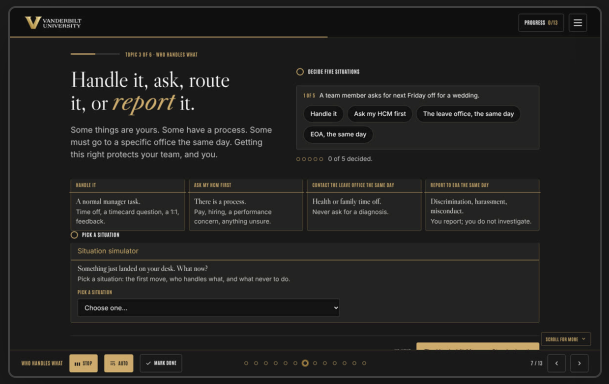
THE STANDARD

Four expectations, fifteen behaviors, sorted from a real week.



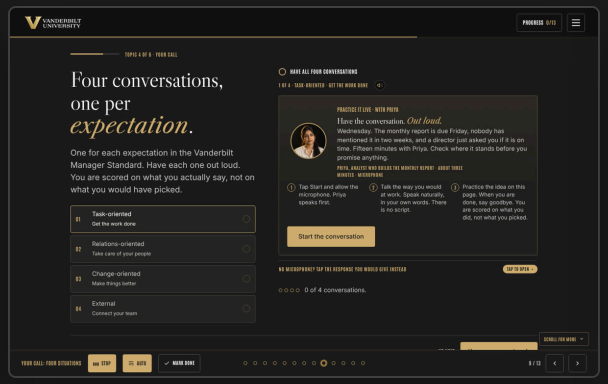
FIVE IDEAS

Each one practiced in a live conversation.



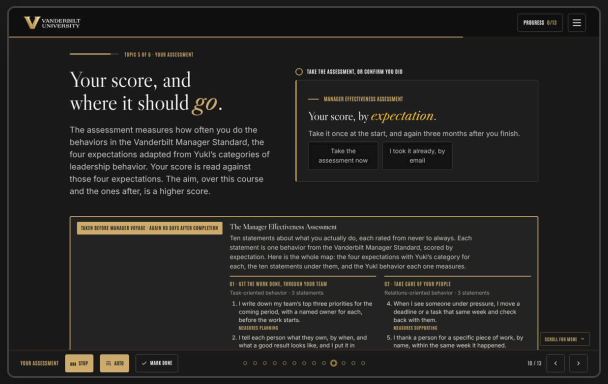
WHO HANDLES WHAT

Handle it, ask, route it, or report it. Five situations.



YOUR CALL

Four conversations out loud, scored on what you say.



YOUR SCORE

Read against the standard. A target for the re-up.

Thirty-five minutes. Live at manager-voyage.vercel.app/foundation. We will click through it in the room.

02 · PROTOTYPE REVEAL · QUARTERLY

The four-week *cohort*.

Fifty managers a quarter, with their own teams, in their own words.

WEEK 1 · IN THE CLASSROOM · 3 HOURS

What it means to manage

The mission, your line, the hard conversation out loud.

WEEK 2 · VIRTUAL · UNDER 90 MIN

Goals, 1:1s, difficult conversations

The 1:1 that turns difficult.

WEEK 3 · VIRTUAL · UNDER 90 MIN

Coaching and mentoring

Coach, then hand it over.

WEEK 4 · IN THE CLASSROOM · 2 HOURS

The capstone

The performance conversation, the Playbook presented.

One Playbook, started in the room, one section a week, presented whole in week four.

LOGISTICS AND WHAT EVERY PARTICIPANT PRODUCES

Logistics

- **Week one.** Three hours in the classroom, facilitated by the Futures Learning Hub from the cohort site, with timers, talk notes, and a QR code on every page.
- **Weeks two and three.** Virtual, on the manager's own time, capped at ninety minutes.
- **Week four.** Two hours in the classroom. Managers present to peers and their business unit leader.
- **Seats.** Fifty a quarter. Units outside the central budget are billed per seat.

Deliverables

- **Manager Playbook.** The written personal operating system: philosophy, 1:1 framework, delegation and growth plan, performance practice.
- **Integrated Management Model.** A one-page model of how the four expectations connect for this manager. Synthesis, not attendance.
- **Team Development Plan.** A 90-day plan for the actual team: names, goals, growth moves. Challenged by peers and presented in week four.

The cohort, *week by week*.

BEFORE

Set your team

Four taps. Every scenario rewrites itself.

WEEK 1 · 03 MAKE THINGS BETTER

What it means to manage

Classroom · 3 hours

WEEK 2 · 01 GET THE WORK DONE

Goals, 1:1s, and difficult conversations

Virtual · under 90 minutes

WEEK 3 · 02 TAKE CARE OF YOUR PEOPLE

Coaching and mentoring

Virtual · under 90 minutes

WEEK 4 · 04 CONNECT YOUR TEAM

Performance, talent, and your Playbook

Classroom · 2 hours · the capstone

EACH WEEK IN DETAIL

Week 1 · In the classroom · 3 hours

ROOM	The mission, fifteen minutes: what your team makes possible, in one sentence. The pulse, first reading.
ACTIVITIES	Your voyage on a timeline, from the work you were hired for to year one. A week of your own work sorted into the four expectations. Which expectation your team needs most, and the habit that serves it.
LAB	The hard conversation, fifty minutes: the three-line frame, a demonstration, pairs, then live with Sam on your phone.
PLAYBOOK	Section 1: Manager Philosophy, written and read aloud to your four.

Week 2 · Virtual · under 90 minutes

CORE	How to Manage Difficult Conversations, in Oracle Learning, 30 minutes.
LAB	SparkWise, 45 minutes: conversation prep with peers. Bring the one you have been putting off; leave with it framed in three lines.
SIMULATION	The 1:1 that turns difficult. Dev has missed two dates and opens as if nothing is wrong. Ten minutes, tailored to your team.
PLAYBOOK	Section 2: cadence, agenda, three goals per person, your opening sentence.

The cohort · Week by week, *continued*.

EACH WEEK IN DETAIL

Week 3 · Virtual · under 90 minutes

CORE	Coaching Skills for Leaders and Managers, in Oracle Learning, 35 minutes.
LAB	SparkWise, 40 minutes: the delegation lab and coach or correct. What you will hand off this month, to whom, with what boundary.
SIMULATION	Coach, then hand it over. Priya wants to grow and expects you to tell her how. Ask first; then a real decision with one boundary and a date.
PLAYBOOK	Section 3: one line per person, where they want to be, the stretch assignment, the rung.

Week 4 · In the classroom · 2 hours

RECAP	The four expectations read back against three weeks: what you tried, what held, what did not.
PRACTICE	The performance conversation with Marcus, who expects a promotion you cannot give this cycle. Pairs, then live.
PRESENT	Five minutes each in fours, business unit leaders in the room: the sentence at the center, the team goal, one person's plan by name, the habit you kept. Peers challenge one goal, one move, one date.
CLOSE	The pulse, second reading, beside the week-one answers. The 90-day reassessment date.

02 · PROTOTYPE REVEAL · ALWAYS AVAILABLE

The Manager *Portal* and who to call.

Every template, policy link and contact. Open from day one, never taken away.

TEMPLATES	1:1 agenda, conversation frame, delegation ladder, Playbook.
POLICY	Leave, flexible work, accommodations, performance.
BEYOND	Vetted podcasts, videos, guides.

WHO TO CALL

Same-day routes and everyday *help*.

YOUR HCM	The first call, the same day.
ENGAGEMENT CONSULTANT	The bigger people questions.
LEAVE OFFICE	FMLA, time off, injuries. Never ask for a diagnosis.
EOA	Report the same day. You do not investigate.

02 · PROTOTYPE REVEAL

How it was built, and how impact is *measured*.

THE EXPERT GROUP

Seven divisions

Set the rules and the Day 30 and 60 bar.

THE PILOT · MARCH 26, 2026

Fifteen managers, eight units

Completed it all. Shaped the design.

READY NOW

Built and tested

Assignment from the HR record, the course, the cohort site, the Portal.

JANUARY 2027

Launch

All managers. First cohort of fifty that quarter.

80%

of M1 to M5 managers enrolled

3 of 4

expectations improved per manager, at 90 days

10

statements, before and after, by expectation

THE OUTCOMES WE EXPECT, AND HOW WE WILL SEE THEM

Engaged

- Managers who understand the role, take ownership of it, and stay at Vanderbilt.
- **How we will see it:** enrollment and Day 60 completion in Oracle Learning against the 80 percent target; cohort seats filled each quarter.

Supporting

- Teams with clear expectations, timely feedback, and the confidence to raise concerns.
- **How we will see it:** assessment gains in getting the work done and taking care of people.

Championing

- Managers who can explain Vanderbilt's purpose in their own words and connect the team's work to it.
- **How we will see it:** assessment gains in making things better and connecting the team; completion of the Vanderbilt & Nashville track.

The standard and the assessment are adapted from Yukl's taxonomy of leadership behavior (2012): the four expectations are his four categories and the ten statements are ten of his fifteen behaviors. An adaptation for Vanderbilt, not a validated instrument, and not a performance evaluation.

Feedback from *DAR, Facilities, VBOM and USAC* staff.

We are meeting with DAR, Facilities, VBOM and USAC staff, and have shared the Foundations course with each of them. Their feedback shapes the next version.

THE GROUPS

- Development and Alumni Relations
- Facilities
- Vanderbilt Business Operations Managers
- University Staff Advisory Council

WHO WE ARE MEETING WITH

- Stacey Crowhurst
- Kylie Ross
- Doug Hunter
- Jennifer Bennett
- Kristen Conoley
- Jeremy Bourgoin
- Alex Enferadi

WHAT THEY HAVE

- The Foundations course, to take end to end
- The manager's timeline, day one to ninety
- The four expectations and the assessment

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

- Does it fit a week in your unit?
- What would you change before January?
- Who should be in the first fifty?

Discussion: where the feedback agrees, where it differs, what we *change*.

CONVERGES

- Practical over theoretical: real conversations, real templates.
- Learn by doing, on your own team.
- One standard, the same in every unit.
- A Portal with names, not a library.

DIVERGES

- Time: three hours in the room in week one, or two?
- Hourly teams: do the virtual weeks fit a shift?
- Cohort mix: across units, or within a division first?
- The score: private to the manager, or shared with their leader?

WHAT WE CHANGE

- What we keep as it is.
- What we change before the next version.
- What we park until after the January launch.
- Who owns each change, and by when.

Decided in the room. Owners and dates go on the next steps slide.

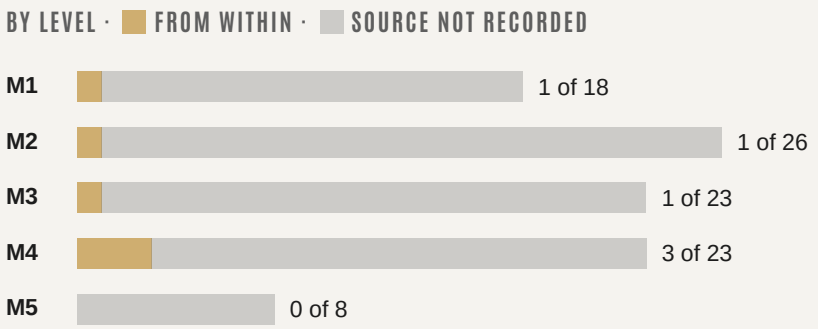
Hiring manager data: *internal* versus external.

Six of 98 management postings filled from October 2025 to September 2026 came from within. The other 92 have no recorded source and are likely external, not confirmed.

98 management postings filled

6 filled from within, 6 percent

92 source not recorded, likely external



31 internal moves into or up a management level this year. **25** of them matched no posting: promotions happen off the posting process.

Where the unrecorded fills sit: Business Services 15 · Public Safety 9 · DAR 8 · Operations 6 · Provost 6 · Facilities 3

Open item · Hiring manager data, *continued*.

THE ASK, THE FULL TABLES, AND HOW TO READ THE NUMBERS

The ask

- **Record the fill source.** Ask PCB whether Oracle Recruiting can require internal or external on every filled management requisition from January, so the next report is a count, not an estimate.
- **Count the off-posting promotions.** Twenty-five people moved into or up management without a posting. Manager Voyage enrolls them from the HR record either way; the question is whether the standard reaches them on day one.
- **Use the pilot partners.** DAR filled eight management roles with no recorded source this year and Facilities three. Both are places to test the standard where hiring is live.

Internal moves into management

PATH	MATCHED A POSTING	NO POSTING	TOTAL
Individual contributor to manager	0	9	9
Other non-manager to manager	1	9	10
Manager to a higher level	5	7	12

Filled postings with no recorded source, by unit

WORK UNIT	POSTINGS
Business Services	15
Public Safety	9
Development and Alumni Relations	8
Division of Operations and the Campus Network	6
Office of the Provost	6
Vanderbilt University	6
Athletics and Student Recreation	4
Finance, Peabody, Facilities, Communications, IT	3 each
Twenty other units	1 to 2 each

How to read this

Filled from within: a filled management requisition matched to an internal person's job change with medium confidence; no fill reached the confirmed level. **Source not recorded:** a filled requisition with no matching internal move; most likely external. **Internal moves:** staff whose job changed into a management classification or to a higher one; some appear twice. Source: Revised Internal Promotions Report, run October 14, 2026. Aggregate counts only.

Next *steps*.

01

THIS WEEK

Lock the changes

Every change agreed today gets an owner and a date, written into the open-items list.

02

NOVEMBER

Pilot partners and VBOM

DAR and Facilities walk the next version with their own teams. VBOM feedback folded in.

03

DECEMBER

Next version, ready for launch

Flows connected, SparkWise labs published, facilitators briefed, fill source recorded in Oracle Recruiting.

04

JANUARY 2027

Launch, fifty seats

Compliance and the Foundation course assigned from the HR record. First cohort opens. First reassessment in April.

Manager Voyage · Futures Learning Hub · People, Culture and Belonging · Vanderbilt University